

Cary Jones

Staff Software Engineer | Backend Systems, AWS Platform & Reliability

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SUMMARY

Staff-level backend engineer and technical lead with 15+ years shipping production-grade application code and owning the **AWS cloud infrastructure** it runs on. Systems thinker who bridges elegant APIs and scalable platform architecture — microservices, event-driven pipelines, PostgreSQL optimization, caching layers, and container orchestration on **ECS and Kubernetes**. Proven track record driving **reliability, performance, and developer velocity** through CI/CD paved roads, reusable libraries, and hands-on mentorship. Deep Python expertise with production experience in Go and Node.js; comfortable leading architecture assessments, hardening plans, and high-impact initiatives across complex codebases.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Backend Engineering:** Python (FastAPI, Django, Flask, Asyncio), Go, Node.js, RESTful API design, microservices, design patterns, pytest, test-driven development
- **AWS & Platform:** EC2, ECS, Fargate, Lambda, RDS, S3, VPC networking, IAM, Docker, Kubernetes, Linux administration, cloud architecture ownership
- **Distributed Systems:** Event-driven architecture, message queues/topics, async processing, caching (Redis), high-concurrency workloads, idempotent pipelines
- **Data & Performance:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, SQL optimization, query indexing, ORM/metaprogramming abstractions, capacity-minded design
- **Reliability & DevOps:** 99.99% uptime production experience, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI), monitoring-minded operations, incident prevention, documentation
- **Technical Leadership:** Staff/Tech Lead initiatives, architecture roadmaps, code review standards, mentorship, Agile/Scrum, cross-team delivery

KEY IMPACT

- Architected AWS event-driven pipelines (ECS, Fargate, Airflow) processing **2.5M+ daily transactions** with **99.95% accuracy** and reliable retry semantics.
- Delivered enterprise backend systems at Disney with **99.99% uptime**, processing **\$10M+ in daily transaction metrics**; co-architected batch optimization cutting runtime from **8 hours to 45 minutes**.
- Built containerized Python microservices on AWS, increasing throughput by **45%** and reducing API latency below **120ms**.
- Created ORM/metaprogramming abstractions reducing database boilerplate by **50%** and query execution time by **28%** — scalable primitives that accelerated team delivery.

- Established CI/CD and AI-augmented engineering workflows (Cursor, Copilot, Claude), raising test coverage from **65% to 92%** and feature velocity by **35–40%**.
- Led cross-functional engineering teams as Scrum Master, accelerating MVP timelines by **3 weeks** while maintaining production stability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineering Consultant / Technical Lead

Jan 2023 – Present | Los Angeles, CA / Remote

CGJSoftware, Inc.

- Write and architect production Python backend services (FastAPI, Django) while owning AWS deployment topology — ECS, Fargate, Lambda, RDS, S3 — ensuring cloud architecture supports software delivery.
 - Evaluate and evolve client platform architecture for scale: data volume growth, API surface expansion, and multi-service reliability.
 - Build team leverage through CI/CD tooling, reusable service patterns, code review standards, and documentation that enable faster, safer shipping.
 - Lead performance optimization across application code, PostgreSQL queries, Redis caching, and async processing pipelines.
 - Mentor engineers on backend best practices, operational maturity, and cloud-native design; deliver hands-on code alongside architectural guidance.
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Senior Software Engineer

October 2021 – November 2022 | Disney Corporation, Inc. (Remote)

- Built and maintained high-performance backend modules for enterprise financial and reporting systems at scale in a mission-critical environment.
 - Owned AWS infrastructure reliability for critical reporting applications, achieving **99.99% uptime** through monitoring, optimization, and capacity-aware design.
 - Optimized PostgreSQL interfaces and database layers during large-scale platform migration with **100% data integrity**.
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Python Software Developer and System Architect

July 2019 – October 2021 | CGJSoftware, Inc. (Remote)

- Designed event-driven architectures with AWS Pub/Sub messaging, ensuring **zero data loss** during peak loads.
 - Containerized Python, React, and Node.js applications with Docker; deployed to AWS/GCP, improving deployment frequency by **3x**.
 - Optimized complex SQL and Redshift workloads, increasing reporting query performance by **38%**.
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Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – July 2023 | CVS, Inc. (Remote)

- Led decoupling of legacy monolith into containerized microservices (Docker), improving integration test speed by **50%** and enabling parallel team delivery.
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API Developer, System Architect, DevOps Engineer, and Scrum Master

January 2018 – July 2019 | Alan Health & Science Corp. (Remote)

- Architected secure REST APIs and PostgreSQL data models for HIPAA-compliant platforms serving **500k+ users**; built CI/CD pre-deploy automation and production Linux environments at **99.9% availability**.
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Field Wireman & Communications Specialist

September 1995 – September 1999 | United States Marine Corps

- Deployed and maintained mission-critical systems under strict uptime requirements — disciplined operational mindset applicable to reliability engineering.

EDUCATION

Associate of Science, Computer Electronics

2010 – 2013 | ITT Technical Institute, San Diego, CA (GPA 3.67)

- 15+ years equivalent professional software engineering experience